

test

Staff RTL design · AI-conducted interview · Generated 22 Sep 2026, 03:17 AM

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Rejected

Weak

Key strengths

- None demonstrated relevant to this role
- Candidate was at least honest in later responses about lacking experience

Areas for improvement

- Fundamental mismatch: candidate has no digital IC design, RTL, or hardware background whatsoever
- Needs to build foundational knowledge in SystemVerilog, clock/reset/power domain architecture before considering such roles
- Should not apply to roles requiring 8+ years of specialized IC design experience without any relevant background
- Answers lacked any specificity, technical depth, or concrete examples throughout
- Candidate disengaged from the interview rather than attempting to provide honest, constructive responses

Technical skills

- No evidence of RTL/SystemVerilog knowledge
- No exposure to clocking, reset architecture, or power-domain design
- No familiarity with UPF/CPF power intent authoring
- No knowledge of embedded microcontroller integration, interrupt controllers, or memory maps
- No understanding of PCIe/UCle power management protocols
- Candidate's actual background (SAP MDG, ABAP, BRF+) has zero overlap with digital IC design requirements

Soft skills

- Responses were extremely vague and non-substantive ('minimal, minimal, minimal things')
- Did not attempt to articulate any transferable skills meaningfully
- Asked to stop the interview rather than engage further
- Poor communication and unwillingness to elaborate even when prompted repeatedly

Overall assessment

The candidate is an SAP MDG techno-functional consultant with no background in digital IC design, RTL, clocking, power management, or embedded hardware — all of which are core, non-negotiable requirements for this Staff RTL design role. Every technical question was met with vague deflections ('minimal', 'I don't have') and the candidate ultimately asked to end the interview. There is no evidence of any transferable skill or genuine attempt to engage with the role's requirements, making this a clear rejection.

Questions & answers (19)

1. Your background is in SAP MDG techno-functional consulting rather than digital IC design—can you walk me through any exposure you've had to hardware or chip design, even indirectly, and how

you see that translating to this role? (Hardware/chip design exposure · 0%)

Candidate: It is very clear that I am into this role from past 10 years, so I think, uh, this could help me.

Reference: A strong answer would cite specific hands-on hardware/RTL projects, coursework, or lab work involving digital logic, FPGA/ASIC design, and explain concrete transferable skills such as debugging methodology or systems thinking.

2. Given that this role requires deep RTL, clocking, and power management expertise built over 8+ years, what makes you think this is the right transition for you at this stage? (Motivation for role transition · 0%)

Candidate: Right now I'm looking better. There are opportunities and this is the right time in the market to look into this.

Reference: A credible answer would articulate a genuine, well-reasoned career transition plan backed by concrete upskilling efforts (courses, certifications, personal projects) in digital design.

3. This role requires at least 3 years owning chip infrastructure like clocking, power management, reset, or DFT at a block-lead level. Can you walk me through any exposure you've had to digital IC design or hardware infrastructure work? (Chip infrastructure ownership experience · 0%)

Candidate: I have a minimal experience in digital IEC design where I have designed the internal cooperative design and hardware infrastructure. I have set all my PCs. I have cybersecurity system where we used to set our pieces.

Reference: Should describe specific block-level ownership: reset synchronizer design, clock-domain crossing handling, or power FSM work with concrete examples and design decisions made.

4. Can you describe the specific reset or clocking circuit you worked on academically, and how it compares to the subsystem-owner level scope this role requires, such as multi-power-domain reset architecture? (Reset/clocking circuit design · 0%)

Candidate: It's very minimal expectations or experience I have in this part. I think that is very minimal.

Reference: Should detail a specific reset synchronizer or clock circuit, its states/logic, and how it would scale to a multi-power-domain chip context.

5. Have you had any exposure to hardware design concepts like reset architecture, clock domains, or power-domain partitioning in chips? (Reset architecture/clock domain/power partitioning · 0%)

Candidate: I have very little.

Reference: Should explain fundamentals of reset domains, synchronizers, and power partitioning with an example, even from academic coursework.

6. Given that gap, what makes you interested in transitioning into a chip infrastructure design role, and what related technical skills do you believe would transfer? (Transferable skills for chip infrastructure · 0%)

Candidate: Very minimal, minimal, minimal things.

Reference: Should identify specific transferable skills such as systematic debugging, structured configuration management, or governance rigor and connect them meaningfully to IC design workflows.

7. Have you had any exposure to RTL design, SystemVerilog, or hardware description languages in a prior role or academic setting? (RTL/SystemVerilog exposure · 0%)

Candidate: I do have a little.

Reference: Should describe specific SystemVerilog modules written, synthesis/simulation tools used, and design intent.

8. Can you walk me through a specific FSM or RTL module you designed in that coursework — what were the states, and how did you verify correctness? (FSM/RTL module design · 0%)

Candidate: It's a simple thing, very common thing I did which I am unable to recollect.

Reference: Should walk through actual states, transitions, and verification methodology (testbenches, waveform checks, assertions).

9. Have you had any exposure to embedded systems, microcontroller architecture, or low-level hardware/firmware concepts? (Embedded microcontroller integration · 0%)

Candidate: Yes, I do have it.

Reference: Should describe specific embedded projects involving memory maps, boot sequences, or interrupt handling.

10. Can you walk me through a specific project where you configured an interrupt or memory-mapped peripheral—what was the register-level detail you had to manage?

(Interrupt/memory-mapped peripheral configuration · 0%)

Candidate: Nothing as such.

Reference: Should describe register maps, interrupt vector configuration, and specific peripheral integration details.

11. Have you had any exposure to hardware/software interface definition, low-level firmware bring-up, or embedded systems work? (HW/SW interface definition · 0%)

Candidate: Stops. MMM.

Reference: Should articulate experience defining register interfaces, interrupt controllers, or debug ports and firmware coordination.

12. Can you walk me through the lowest-level system integration work you've done — even outside embedded contexts — such as IDoc/SOAP interface troubleshooting — and how that maps conceptually to defining a hardware/software boundary? (System integration analogy · 0%)

Candidate: Very minimal. Minimal things.

Reference: Should draw a thoughtful analogy between IDoc/SOAP interface debugging and hardware/software boundary definition, showing conceptual transfer of systems thinking.

13. Have you had any exposure to hardware design, RTL, or low-power design techniques like clock gating? (Clock-gating strategy · 0%)

Candidate: I don't have.

Reference: Should discuss ICG cell selection, coarse vs fine-grain gating tradeoffs, and sign-off methodology.

14. Do you have any academic coursework, personal projects, or exposure to RTL/Verilog, power domains, or low-power design concepts that might be relevant here? (Low-power design coursework · 0%)

Candidate: No, I don't have.

Reference: Should cite any relevant coursework or self-study on power domains and low-power design.

15. Have you had any exposure to chip-level power-domain planning, level-shifters, isolation cells, or power state mapping in any prior role or academic project? (Power-domain planning · 0%)

Candidate: No, I don't have.

Reference: Should describe level-shifter/isolation cell placement logic and power-domain partitioning strategy.

16. Can you walk me through how you'd decide where isolation cells are needed versus level-shifters alone, based on what you learned? (Isolation cells vs level-shifters · 0%)

Candidate: I can't remember now.

Reference: Should explain that isolation cells are needed at power-domain boundaries when a domain is powered down to prevent floating signals, while level-shifters handle voltage differences between always-on domains.

17. Have you worked on power intent specification or low-power design sign-off in any capacity? (UPF/CPF power intent · 0%)

Candidate: No, I have not worked on it.

Reference: Should describe UPF authoring experience, power domain definitions, and sign-off checks (e.g., using tools like Synopsys/Cadence).

18. Walk me through a specific case where your UPF power intent caused a mismatch with the physical implementation — how did you debug and resolve it? (UPF/physical implementation mismatch debugging · 0%)

Candidate: I don't have any experience on it.

Reference: Should describe a real debugging scenario involving power domain floorplan mismatches, isolation verification failures, and resolution steps with the physical design team.

19. Have you had any exposure to hardware power management or link-layer protocols like PCIe in a prior technical role or academic project? (PCIe/UCIe power state mapping · 0%)

Candidate: No, I don't have. I would like to stop this interview.

Reference: Should discuss experience mapping chip power states to PCIe/UCIe link power management states (e.g., L0, L1, L2 states) and associated state machine design.